



RIYASUDEEN FAROOK

IT Operations Manager | IT Infrastructure Manager & Digital Transformation Lead

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia (Transferable Iqama)

Email: urias22@gmail.com | Mobile: +966535075778

Portfolio: <https://riyasudeen.me> | LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/riyasudeen-farook/>

Membership: Saudi Council of Engineers (SCE) – Approved Computer Engineer

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Strategic IT Operations Manager with extensive experience in KSA and UAE markets, specializing in IT infrastructure modernization, governance, and service delivery for large-scale holding groups and financial sectors. Expert in orchestrating high-availability environments (>99.9% uptime) across Nutanix AHV, VMware, Microsoft 365, and Hybrid Cloud architectures. Proven track record in aligning IT strategy with business goals through cost-effective automation (n8n, AI integration), rigorous cybersecurity compliance (NCA standards), and vendor management. Adept at leading cross-functional teams and managing OPEX/CAPEX budgets to drive digital transformation and operational resilience.

CORE SKILLS

- IT Strategy & Governance:** ITIL V4 Practices, SLA & KPI Management, DR/BCP Strategy, Vendor & Budget Management, Budgeting (CAPEX/OPEX), Change Management (CAB), Incident/Problem Management.
- Infrastructure & Cloud:** Nutanix AHV, VMware vSphere, Microsoft 365 (Exchange/SharePoint/Teams), Azure AD (Entra ID), Windows Server 2025/2022, Linux (Ubuntu/CentOS), HPE Storage, WSUS, WUfB / feature updates.
- Cybersecurity & Compliance:** Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM), Palo Alto Firewalls, CrowdStrike XDR, Proofpoint Email Security, Veeam Backup & Replication, Vulnerability Management.
- Automation & Innovation:** Workflow Automation (n8n), OpenSearch, Docker/Containerization, Local LLM Deployment (Ollama), PowerShell Scripting, Nextcloud, Passbolt, Zammad Helpdesk system with AI analysis.
- Leadership:** Strategic Planning, Team Leadership / Cross Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Engagement, Business Continuity Management, Leading a cross-functional IT Team of 4 members.

WORK EXPERIENCE

IT Operations Manager / Ajlan & Bros Holding Group | Riyadh, KSA

Jun 2024 - Present

- Strategic Leadership:** Directing IT Operations for a major holding group, overseeing Helpdesk, Infrastructure, and Systems to ensure 99% SLA adherence across multi-site environments.
- Infrastructure Modernization:** Architected and executed the migration of legacy VMware workloads to a Nutanix AHV cluster, enhancing scalability and standardizing VM lifecycle management.
- Cybersecurity Governance:** Enforced strict security baselines for 35+ Microsoft 365 domains; deployed Proofpoint for email security and managed Palo Alto firewall governance to align with corporate risk standards.
- Endpoint Management:** Automated patch management and compliance for corporate endpoints via Microsoft Intune, significantly reducing vulnerability windows and manual administrative overhead.
- Business Continuity:** Designed and implemented a robust Disaster Recovery (DR) strategy using Veeam for M365 and on-premise servers, aligning RPO/RTO metrics with business continuity requirements.
- Innovation & Automation:** Deployed secure on-premise automation services (n8n, OpenSearch, Nextcloud) to enhance system observability and reduce operational friction.
- Stakeholder Management:** Acting as a strategic liaison between internal departments and subsidiary companies to identify technological needs and implement best-in-class IT solutions across multi-site environments.
- Budget Management:** Oversee budgeting, costing & forecast analysis of 10 million+ SAR and cross-functional delivery with Applications/SAP teams & external partners and spearheaded IT Infrastructure & Systems projects.

IT Administrator - Systems & Infrastructure / Dubai Financial Services Authority | Dubai, UAE

Mar 2023 - Mar 2024

- Service Delivery:** Managed IT infrastructure for a regulatory financial body, utilizing SCOM and Ops Manager to reduce system downtime and enhance productivity.

- **Cloud & Identity Management:** Administered a hybrid Active Directory 2022 environment and Microsoft 365 suite (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive), ensuring high availability and secure external collaboration. Managed virtual environments using VMware vCenter (7.0) and vSphere ESXi hosts (7.0)
- **Resilience Planning:** Centralized configuration management and business continuity plans using Veeam and Veritas solutions to ensure rapid recovery from critical errors.
- **Policy Development:** Designed and implemented service call policies and escalation matrices, standardizing support ticket resolution and improving helpdesk efficiency.
- **Business Continuity:** Ensuring optimal operation of the IT Systems & Servers over the organization and maintaining a 99% of system uptime.

IT Executive / Gyma Food Industries (Savola Foods) | Dubai, UAE

Aug 2022 - Mar 2023

- **Operational Efficiency:** Orchestrated a 20% improvement in overall IT operational efficiency and a 15% reduction in response times by streamlining workflows and optimizing team productivity.
- **Service Delivery:** Effectively managed and supported office & factory users with Microsoft Suite including M365 and Dynamics 365.
- **Migration Projects:** Led the cross-tenant migration of 400+ Office 365 users during organizational restructuring, seamlessly handling Mailboxes, OneDrive, and SharePoint data with zero data loss.
- **Vendor & Asset Management:** Managed high-level vendor relationships and prepared RFPs/RFQs for hardware/software procurement, ensuring advantageous Service Level Agreements (SLAs).
- **Multi Tenant Management:** Managed users, groups, and permissions in hybrid Windows Active Directory 2019 across UAE and KSA sites.

IT Engineer / IT Specialist / Ajmal Perfumes Manufacturing | Dubai, UAE

Dec 2018 - Aug 2022

- **Network Optimization:** Implemented proactive monitoring strategies that reduced system downtime by 25% and maintained 99.9% uptime for critical manufacturing and retail applications.
- **Service Delivery:** Performed troubleshooting and maintenance of hardware and software components, including servers, routers, switches, firewalls, and other network devices.
- **ERP Support:** Assisted in the implementation of SAP ERP solutions and supported retail operations across multiple outlets, including SQL database management, also provided support to Orion Oracle 11G, Orion Retail.
- **Process Standardization:** Designed Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for new system integrations and drafted network configuration diagrams to ensure consistent multi-site infrastructure.
- **Proactive Planning:** Drafted cabling and network configuration diagrams, illustrating plans to create repeatable, consistent infrastructures for multi-site facilities.

IT Support & Network Support Engineer / Dora Infotech LLC - Dubai, UAE

Dec 2017 - Nov 2018

- **Network Optimization:** Reduced system downtime by 30% through proactive network monitoring, identifying and resolving issues before they impacted operations.
- **Support / Deployment:** Managed IP PBX and PABX lines, handling installation and troubleshooting at client sites. Installed operating systems, antivirus software, ERP, and various applications like MS Office.
- **Client Support:** Provided on-site technical support, troubleshooting client errors for effective problem resolution. Configured Microsoft Server and maintained Active Directories for AMC Client's employees.
- **CyberSecurity Compliance:** Successfully implemented security protocols, resulting in a 25% decrease in cybersecurity incidents and ensuring the integrity of the organization's data.
- **Service Delivery:** Responded to and resolved an average of 50+ IT support tickets weekly, consistently meeting or exceeding the established service-level agreements (SLAs).

EDUCATIONAL QUALIFICATION

- B.E. Computer Science and Engineering | Aalim Muhammed Salegh College of Engineering (Anna University Affiliated) - Chennai, India, May 2015
- Nutanix Cloud Administration | Nutanix Academy, Sep 2024
- Administering VMware vSphere 8 and vCenter | Udemy, Jun 2024
- CompTIA Security+ | Cybrary IT, Dec 2019
- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) | Sansbound Networking School, Chennai, India, Apr 2016

KEY PROJECTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **M&A Integration:** Executed tenant-to-tenant migrations for M365 services and hybrid-joined accounts during company acquisitions.
 - **Enterprise Deployment:** Deployed Windows 11 in-place upgrades for 250+ laptops using SCCM, streamlining OS transition with minimal user disruption.
 - **Data Center Relocation:** Led the successful data center relocation for AAFAQ (a leading Islamic bank in UAE's semi-government sector), ensuring secure, uninterrupted services.
 - Implemented Unify IP Telephony solution for 170+ users, replacing legacy PBX systems with modern VoIP infrastructure.
 - Completed full IT infrastructure setup for a new branch in Jebel Ali Free Zone, including network configuration, telephony, and CCTV systems.
 - Deployed ManageEngine ServiceDesk Plus with integrated asset management for UAE and KSA offices, improving IT service management and asset visibility.
 - Oversaw Data Center Revamp Project, transitioning legacy servers to Dell VxRail HCI, optimizing rack space, cabling, and power redundancy systems.
-

DRIVING LICENSE

Holding KSA & UAE driving licenses